

MoodMeal AI Recipe

Rajma Chawal (Kidney Bean Curry with Rice)

Why this meal?

This classic Indian comfort meal is perfect for a happy mood and weight gain. Rajma (kidney beans) are packed with complex carbohydrates, protein, and fiber, making them highly nutritious and satisfying. Paired with energy-rich rice, it provides a calorie-dense, wholesome meal that fuels your body and brings a smile to your face, all within your budget.

Required Ingredients

For Rajma Curry:

- Rajma (dried kidney beans): 100g (soaked overnight)
- Onion: 1 medium, finely chopped
- Tomato: 1 medium, pured
- Ginger-garlic paste: 1 tsp
- Green chili: 1 (optional), slit
- Oil: 2 tbsp
- Cumin seeds: 1/2 tsp
- Turmeric powder: 1/4 tsp
- Red chili powder: 1/2 tsp
- Coriander powder: 1 tsp
- Garam masala: 1/2 tsp
- Salt to taste
- Fresh coriander leaves: for garnish

For Rice:

- Basmati rice: 100g
- Water: 200ml
- Salt: a pinch

Recipe

1. ****Prepare Rajma:**** After soaking overnight, drain the water from the rajma. Pressure cook the rajma with 3 cups of fresh water and a pinch of salt for 7-8 whistles or until very soft. Let the pressure release naturally.
2. ****Cook Rice:**** Wash the rice thoroughly. In a separate pot, combine rice, 200ml water, and a pinch of salt. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat, cover, and simmer for 10-12 minutes until water is absorbed and rice is cooked. Let it rest covered for 5 minutes.
3. ****Make Rajma Curry Base:**** Heat oil in a pan or kadai. Add cumin seeds and let them splutter. Add chopped onion and saut until golden brown.
4. ****Add Aromatics & Spices:**** Add ginger-garlic paste and green chili, saut for a minute until fragrant. Add tomato pure and cook until the oil separates.
5. ****Add Dry Spices:**** Stir in turmeric powder, red chili powder, coriander powder, and salt. Cook for 2 minutes, adding a splash of water if needed to prevent burning.
6. ****Combine with Rajma:**** Add the cooked rajma (along with its cooking liquid) to the masala. Mash a few rajma beans gently with the back of a spoon to thicken the gravy.
7. ****Simmer:**** Bring the curry to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 15-20 minutes, allowing flavors to meld. Add garam masala and fresh coriander leaves, mix well, and switch off the heat.
8. ****Serve:**** Serve hot rajma curry with fluffy rice.

Calories: ~580 kcal

Protein: ~22g

Approx Cost: 45-50

Cooking Time: ~60 minutes (excluding overnight soaking)

One Healthy Tip: For an extra boost in healthy fats and calories, drizzle a teaspoon of ghee over your rice before serving. This enhances flavor and supports healthy weight gain.